

All-Star team

Koufax, Greenberg tops in Jewish all-star vote

Inside baseball fan Marshall H. Berkson of Palm Island has a unique hobby: he collects information and stories on Jewish athletes.

Berkson, originally from Chicago, put some research time into his all-star Jewish team ballot. Before we give you Berkson's picks and some of his notes, here's the all-star Jewish team voted by our fans:

Sandy Koufax pitcher
Moe Berg catcher
Hank Greenberg first base
Rod Carew second base
Al Rosen third base
Buddy Myer shortstop
Sid Gordon outfield
Ron Blomberg outfield
Benny Kauff outfield
Former New York Yankee Blomberg might have had a career that never quite fulfilled its promise ... but that didn't keep Blomberg off this Inside Baseball All-Star Jewish team. Outfielders who came up short included Richie Scheinblum, Norm Miller, Morrie Arnovich, John Lowenstein, Art Shamsky and Goody Rosen.

Koufax and Greenberg were the only unanimous picks at their positions. A few voters gave honorable mention to Bo Belinsky and Ken Holtzman as pitchers behind Koufax, and Mike Epstein at first behind Greenberg.

Moe Berg was out-voted by Johnny Kling at catcher but Kling's widow recently said Kling was not Jewish. We decided to make Rod Carew eligible for the all-Jewish team as a convert.

Berkson, himself a Jewish athlete (he was a starting forward on Ray Meyer's 1943 DePaul team that included George Mikan), has Koufax

at pitcher with Greenberg, Myer, Al Rosen and Andy Cohen as his infield.

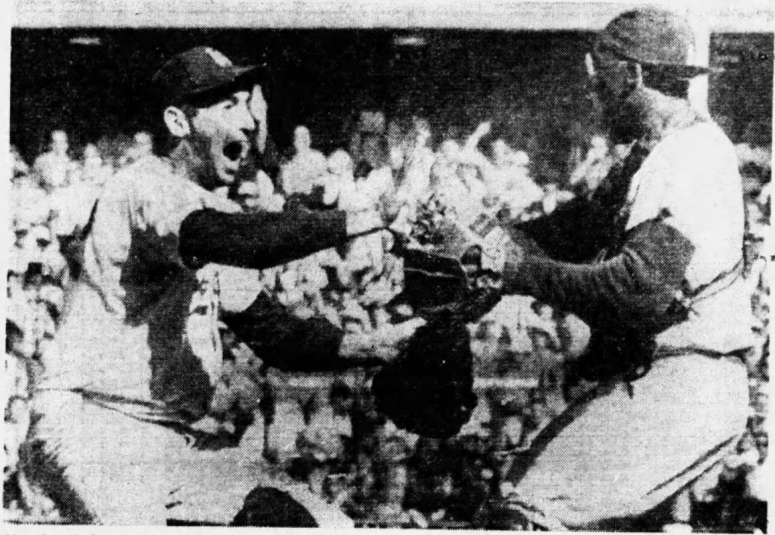
Gordon, Morrie Arnovich and Kauff are his outfielders with Larry Sherry as relief pitcher.

"Of course, choosing Hall of Famer Hank Greenberg was no problem," Berkson said. "Greenberg batted .313 and had 331 homers. He led the American League four times in homers and RBI.

"There was no one like Sandy Koufax," Berkson said. "He led the league in ERA the last five years he played and won 25, 19, 26 and 27 his last four years."

"Buddy (Myer) led the American League in hitting in 1935 with a .349 mark," Berkson said. "I don't know if fans remember Andy Cohen, but he tried to replace Rogers Hornsby for the New York Giants and couldn't quite do it.

"Benny Kauff played in the Federal League from 1912 to 1920 and had a lifetime .311 average," Berkson said. "Now Gordon was easy. He had a .283 lifetime average.



Koufax, left, and Roseboro savor 1963 Series win over Yanks

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